- Sterility
- Low birth weight babies
- Congenital defects in the child- cleft lip and cleft palate

Autism is a mental condition, present from early childhood, characterized by great difficulty in communicating and forming relationships with other people and in using language and abstract concepts

Vitamin B_{12}-Cyanocobalamine

This vitamin is destroyed by heat.

Daily requirements: 1-3 µg

Sources

Foods of animal origin, also synthesized by bacteria.



Functions

- DNA Synthesis
- Stimulates and promotes maturation of RBC's

Its absorption from the intestines requires a factor called 'intrinsic factor (IF)' secreted by the stomach. It is a specific protein secreted by the mucosal cells lining the stomach. IF binds and absorbs vitamin B_{12}.

Deficiency Syndrome

- Pernicious anemia
- Infertility
- Neurological and mental disturbances

Vitamin C

Vitamin C is also known as ascorbic acid. It is an antioxidant and water soluble vitamin.

Daily requirements: up to 40 mg

Sources: Citrus fruits (amla, guava, lemon, orange, tomato), green leafy vegetables.



Functions

- Helps in wound healing
- Prevents bleeding
- Antioxidant

Heat and cooking destroys the Vitamin C.

Deficiency Syndrome

Scurvy- Painful swelling of gums and joints. Multiple hemorrhages specially in gums, skin and mucus membrane delayed wound healing.



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